

DAY 10

Sprint Review & Sprint Retrospective

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the purpose of the Sprint Review and how it differs from the Retrospective
- Learn how to facilitate a Sprint Review with stakeholders
- Understand Retrospective formats: Start-Stop-Continue, 4Ls, Mad-Sad-Glad
- Learn how to capture action items from a Retrospective and track them
- YouTube Search Terms:
 - "Sprint review vs sprint retrospective"
 - "How to run a sprint review meeting"
 - "Sprint retrospective formats explained"
 - "Agile retrospective techniques"
- Recommended Channels:
 - Atlassian
 - Agile Alliance
 - PM Majik

Tasks:

- Study the Sprint Review — understand that its purpose is to inspect the Increment and adapt the Product Backlog, not just a demo — understand who attends (team + stakeholders), what is shown, and what the output is
- Study three retrospective formats in detail — Start-Stop-Continue (practical and simple), 4Ls (Liked, Learned, Lacked, Longed for), and Mad-Sad-Glad (emotion-focused) — understand when to use each format and why format choice matters
- Write a Sprint 1 Review agenda document — what the team will demo, how it will be structured, what feedback is expected from stakeholders, and how feedback is captured and turned into backlog items
- Write a full Sprint 1 Retrospective document using the Start-Stop-Continue format — simulate 5 team members' inputs, identify the top 3 improvement actions, assign each action to a specific person, and note how you will check if it was done in Sprint 2

Deliverable

- Sprint Review agenda document
- Sprint Retrospective document with simulated team inputs and 3 action items
- Short note: why PMs who skip retrospectives always repeat the same mistakes

→ Sprint Review

A Sprint Review is held at the end of a sprint to inspect the completed product increment and gather feedback from stakeholders. Its purpose is not simply to demonstrate completed work. Instead, it helps the team evaluate progress toward the Product Goal and adapt the Product Backlog based on stakeholder feedback.

Who Attends?

- Product Owner
- Scrum Master
- Development Team
- Stakeholders (customers, managers, business representatives)
- Project Manager (if applicable)

What Happens During a Sprint Review?

1. Sprint Goal is reviewed.
2. Completed features are demonstrated.
3. Stakeholders provide feedback.
4. Market changes and business priorities are discussed.
5. Product Backlog is updated based on feedback.

Outputs of a Sprint Review

- Stakeholder feedback
- Updated Product Backlog
- New requirements and enhancement ideas
- Better understanding of product direction

Sprint Review vs Sprint Retrospective

Sprint Review	Sprint Retrospective
Focuses on Product	Focuses on Process
Includes Stakeholders	Internal Team Only
Reviews Product Increment	Reviews Team Performance
Discusses What Was Built	Discusses How Work Was Done
Updates Product Backlog	Creates Improvement Actions
Business-Oriented	Team-Oriented

→ Retrospective Formats

※ Start-Stop-Continue

A simple and action-oriented retrospective format.

Questions:

Start : What should we begin doing?

Stop : What should we stop doing?

Continue : What is working well and should continue?

Best Used When

- New Agile teams
- Quick retrospectives
- Teams seeking actionable improvements

Benefits

- Easy to understand
- Produces clear action items
- Encourages practical thinking

※ 4Ls Format

Categories

Liked : What did we enjoy?

Learned : What did we learn?

Lacked : What was missing?

Longed For : What would we like in the future?

Best Used When

- Reflecting on learning experiences
- End of major milestones
- New projects

Benefits

- Encourages reflection
- Captures team learning
- Highlights future needs

※ Mad-Sad-Glad Format

Categories

Mad : What frustrated us?

Sad : What disappointed us?

Glad : What made us happy?

Best Used When:

- Team morale issues
- High-stress projects
- Conflict resolution

Benefits

- Reveals emotional concerns
- Improves team relationships
- Encourages honest discussion

※ Why Format Choice Matters

Different teams face different challenges.

- Start-Stop-Continue focuses on actions.
- 4Ls focuses on learning.
- Mad-Sad-Glad focuses on emotions.

Selecting the right format helps uncover the most valuable insights and improvements for the team.

→ Sprint Review Agenda Document

Project: Expense Tracker Application

Sprint: Sprint 1 (3 Weeks)

Sprint Goal : Deliver core user authentication and expense management features.

Attendees

- Product Owner
- Scrum Master
- Development Team
- Stakeholders
- Project Manager

Meeting Duration

60 Minutes

Time	Activity
0–5 min	Welcome and Sprint Goal Review
5–15 min	Demo: User Registration Feature
15–25 min	Demo: User Login Feature
25–35 min	Demo: Add Expense Functionality
35–45 min	Demo: View Expense List
45–55 min	Stakeholder Feedback Discussion
55–60 min	Summary and Next Steps

Features Demonstrated

1. User Registration
2. User Login
3. Add Expense
4. View Expenses

Expected Stakeholder Feedback

- Ease of use of registration process
- User interface design
- Additional expense categories required
- Suggestions for reporting features
- Performance and usability concerns

Feedback Capture Process

1. Feedback recorded by Scrum Master.
2. Product Owner reviews all suggestions.
3. New requirements converted into Product Backlog Items.
4. Priority assigned during Backlog Refinement.
5. Approved items considered for Sprint 2 Planning.

Outputs

- Stakeholder feedback collected
- Product Backlog updated
- Sprint Goal reviewed
- Future enhancements identified

→ Sprint 1 Retrospective Document (Start-Stop-Continue)

Meeting Objective: To review the team's performance during Sprint 1, identify what went well and what needs improvement, identify improvements for Sprint 2, and create action items to improve efficiency and collaboration in Sprint 2.

Team Members:

- Aayush (Developer)
- Sneha (Developer)
- Hardik (Tester)
- Aditya (UI Designer)
- Aashi (Scrum Master)

Team Inputs:

Name (Role)	START, STOP, CONTINUE
Aayush (Developer)	Start : Daily code reviews Stop : Delaying integration until the end of sprint Continue : Pair programming sessions
Sneha (Developer)	Start : Better task estimation discussions Stop : Taking multiple tasks simultaneously Continue : Daily communication with tester
Hardik (Tester)	Start : Testing features earlier Stop : Waiting for complete module delivery Continue : Maintaining bug tracking sheet
Aditya (UI Designer)	Start : Design reviews before development Stop : Last-minute UI changes Continue : Sharing wireframes early
Aashi (Scrum Master)	Start : Mid-sprint progress checks Stop : Unclear acceptance criteria Continue : Daily standup meetings

Common Themes Identified

1. Earlier testing
2. Better estimation
3. Clear acceptance criteria
4. Continuous integration
5. Improved communication

Top 3 Improvement Actions

Action Item	Owner	Success Check in Sprint 2
Introduce code review before merging	Sneha	100% PR review compliance
Define acceptance criteria before sprint starts	Aashi	Every user story contains acceptance criteria
Begin testing within 24 hours of feature completion	Hardik	Reduced defect leakage and earlier bug discovery

Follow-Up Plan for Sprint 2:

Weekly Check

- Scrum Master reviews action item progress during standups.

Sprint 2 Review

- Measure PR review compliance.
- Verify all stories contain acceptance criteria.
- Check testing start time and defect trends.

Expected Outcome

- Better quality releases
- Reduced rework
- Improved sprint predictability

→ **Why PMs Who Skip Retrospectives Always Repeat the Same Mistakes**

Retrospectives are a key part of continuous improvement in Agile teams. They provide a structured opportunity to review what went well, identify challenges, and determine improvements for future sprints. When project managers skip retrospectives, recurring issues such as poor communication, inaccurate estimations, unclear requirements, delayed testing, and workflow bottlenecks often remain unresolved. As a result, the same problems continue to appear sprint after sprint, reducing team productivity and product quality. Effective retrospectives help teams identify root causes, implement improvement actions, and track their progress in future sprints. This continuous feedback loop enables teams to learn from experience, improve their processes, and deliver better project outcomes over time.